



Make your kid build his own toy

Autodesk launches an app 'Tinkerplay' to let kids build their own toys and 3D print them with minimal assistance. <http://dgit.in/1MQIdCX>



Boost camera performance

Researchers find that controlled sound waves in cameras can increase sensor's performance in low-light conditions. <http://dgit.in/TinQuak>

Moto E (2nd Gen) 3G

Not the king of budget anymore

With the new version of the Moto E now official, Motorola has now officially refreshed its entire range of smartphones. The new Moto E though comes with some confusing choices. For one, why would Motorola go with 3G and 4G SKUs for the device? Also, what sense does it make to put the Snapdragon 200 SoC in the 3G version when almost every other manufacturer with a phone in this price segment is going with the newer Snapdragon 410? Why give a 64-bit OS but not a 64-bit processor?

Well, the company simply says that the choice of processors won't affect the performance and that Motorola couldn't have provided the ₹6,999 price tag if they used the Snapdragon 410. Xiaomi and Lenovo are both offering the 410 while Micromax's Yu is selling the Snapdragon 615 at ₹8,999. We understand that Motorola's QA specifications might not allow cutting any corners elsewhere which is why they've gone with the said price. Anyway, all this affects the Moto E dearly since the Indian market happens to be a very price conscious one.

Turning on the device, you won't be disappointed with the overall UI experience. Android Lollipop is very lightly skinned by Motorola and runs with little to no lags on the device. The lags will pop up the minute you turn on a game like Marvel: Contest of Champions. Given that this isn't a phone to play high end games in, the performance difference becomes very apparent. The performance of the Moto E is better than the Lumia 532 and 435, but nowhere close to what the Redmi 2 and Lenovo A6000 can provide.

Next, Motorola 'heard' its users, who complained about the lack of a front camera. As a result, the company put in a VGA camera. Yes, you read that right, a VGA camera in this day and age. While this camera will make your selfies look bad, the rear 5MP camera is no great shakes either. Images from the Moto E are lack lustre and lack details. The camera completely falls

behind the competition under low light conditions as well.

The overall design language has been kept the same, but the new Moto E is a slightly bigger device than its predecessor. That said, it is sufficiently light and the new rubberised grips around the side of the smartphone add to the ergonomics. It's easy to hold and easier to use. In fact, some might even say that the new Moto E is a good looking device for its price.

Speaking of the bigger size, the new Moto E comes with a 4.5 inch display, up from 4.3 inch in its predecessor. While this is just about acceptable for the budget range today, the 540x960p resolution surely isn't. The new Moto E has good viewing angles, but that's about all that you can say about it. The colour reproduction is not quite as good as we would have liked it to be and the display lacks the sharpness that competing models provide.

The ₹6,999 price tag seems too much for the new Moto E. While the smartphone is good for a first time mobile user, it doesn't make sense for everyone. The older version used to provide very good value with the same price tag, but the new one just pales against the competition. Both the Lenovo A6000 and Xiaomi Redmi 2 are superior smartphones, which provide better value than the Moto E (2nd Gen).

What's even more unfortunate is that the 3G and 4G separation will drive up the cost of the 4G version. That one comes with the newer generation processor and can actually take on the Redmi 2 and Lenovo A6000. Instead, it will lose value thanks to the higher pricing. As things stand, it seems Motorola is depending solely on its brand value and customer service to gain the consumer's interest. The new Moto E is no longer the king of the budget segment and doesn't provide the best value for the price. The only thing it really has over its competitors is Android Lollipop out of the box.

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Price
₹6,999

67

Features	75
Design	70
Performance	67
Multimedia	46
Value	71

Specifications

Display: 4.5-inch 540x960 pixel; **Processor:** 1.2 Ghz Qualcomm Snapdragon 200 quad-core; **Camera:** 5 MP rear, VGA front; **Storage:** 8 GB, expandable to 32 GB; **RAM:** 1 GB; **Operating System:** Android 5.0 Lollipop; **Battery:** 2390 mAh

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